

Pankaj Aswal

Senior DevOps / SRE / Platform Engineer | Kubernetes | AWS | Cloud-Native | IaC

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps / Platform Engineer with 10+ years designing, operating, and continuously improving Kubernetes-based production platforms across FinTech and Telecom domains. Deep hands-on expertise in Kubernetes cluster administration, Terraform IaC, CI/CD automation, and SRE observability practices. Proven track record managing 50+ microservices on AWS EKS with rolling, canary, and blue-green deployments, migrating large-scale clusters with near-zero downtime, and driving 20-25% cloud cost reduction through infrastructure optimization and automation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Kubernetes & Container Platforms: Kubernetes (EKS, on-premises cluster administration, troubleshooting), Docker, Helm, Kustomize, Istio service mesh, HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler, namespaces, RBAC, network policy, multi-cluster operations, blue-green and canary deployments, Argo Rollouts

Infrastructure as Code & Automation: Terraform, Ansible, Helm, Packer - multi-environment provisioning (dev, staging, production), automated operational workflows using Python, Bash, and Groovy, Git branch governance pipelines

CI/CD & GitOps: Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Argo CD, Argo Rollouts - pipeline design and optimization, build automation, deployment automation, rolling and canary release strategies, artifact promotion, GitOps workflows

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EKS, RDS, EC2, IAM, S3, CloudWatch, CloudFormation, Route 53), Azure (AKS, App Service), GCP - Linux system administration, networking (VPC, load balancers, DNS), containerization

Observability & SRE: Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), OpenSearch, NewRelic, AWS CloudWatch - SLO/SLI-driven alerting, incident response and RCA, MTTR reduction, capacity planning, chaos engineering principles

Programming & Scripting: Python, Bash, Groovy, YAML, Java - automation scripts for health checks, operational workflows, compliance reporting, and infrastructure lifecycle management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior DevOps Engineer

adidas | Gurugram, India | Mar 2023 - Present

- Designed, operated, and continuously improved a Kubernetes EKS production platform running 50+ microservices, implementing rolling, canary, and blue-green deployment strategies to improve platform availability and deployment reliability.
- Implemented Kubernetes autoscaling and cluster governance using HPA, VPA, KEDA, and resource quotas, improving workload efficiency and reducing infrastructure waste across multiple production environments.
- Migrated 120+ AWS RDS PostgreSQL instances from Intel to Graviton architecture using Multi-AZ failover strategies and automated runbooks, reducing infrastructure costs by 20-25% while improving database throughput and latency.
- Optimized cloud resource utilization across AWS accounts through infrastructure tuning and capacity planning, achieving a 20% reduction in monthly cloud spend.
- Collaborated with development teams to improve application scalability and operational excellence, implementing Kubernetes resource quotas and autoscaling policies aligned to traffic growth.
- Automated Git branch governance in Jenkins and Groovy, implementing retention-based cleanup pipelines that improved Jenkins indexing speed and enforced compliance policies at scale.
- Automated operational workflows using Python, Bash, Jenkins, and Docker, significantly reducing manual intervention and deployment overhead across development and production environments.

Senior DevOps Engineer

Paytm Payments Bank | Noida, India | Oct 2018 - Mar 2023

- Built observability platforms using Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, and ELK Stack across 100+ services, reducing incident detection time by 15% and improving production visibility for development and operations teams.
- Developed SLO-driven monitoring and alerting across Kubernetes, cloud, and application layers using SRE best practices, reducing production system errors by 20%.
- Led migration of on-premises Kubernetes clusters to AWS EKS for banking workloads using blue-green deployment strategies with Istio service mesh, achieving production migration with less than 50 minutes of downtime.
- Implemented Kubernetes RBAC policies, namespaces, RoleBindings, and ServiceAccounts to enforce least-privilege access controls and strengthen cluster security posture.
- Designed automated migration workflows using Velero, Argo Rollouts, and pre-flight validation checks to ensure backup integrity, rollback readiness, and seamless traffic cutover at each stage.
- Conducted infrastructure capacity planning and resource optimization that supported 30% traffic growth without downtime or service degradation.
- Automated repetitive operational processes using Python, Bash, and Groovy, improving deployment consistency and engineering productivity across all environments.

Site Reliability Engineer

Airtel | Noida, India | Sep 2017 - Oct 2018

- Operated Azure and GCP-based telecom production platforms using Kubernetes, Docker, Jenkins, and Datadog to maintain high service availability for critical cloud-native workloads.
- Improved platform reliability by 30% through proactive monitoring, incident response optimization, and cross-functional collaboration with development and operations teams.
- Performed root cause analysis and troubleshooting for distributed production systems, reducing MTTR and improving incident resolution efficiency.

SRE / DevOps Engineer

IBM | Noida, India | Feb 2016 - Sep 2017

- Managed incident response, production support, and operational activities for enterprise telecom infrastructure, supporting Linux-based distributed environments and troubleshooting complex operational issues.
- Coordinated cross-functional knowledge transfer and operational transition activities, ensuring uninterrupted service continuity across infrastructure handovers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Kubernetes On-Premises to AWS EKS Migration

Technologies: AWS EKS, Kubernetes, Istio, Velero, Argo Rollouts, Terraform, Prometheus, Grafana

- End-to-end migration of banking Kubernetes clusters to AWS EKS: blue-green deployment, automated rollback with Velero, Istio traffic splitting, pre-flight validation, and continuous Prometheus/Grafana monitoring - less than 50 minutes of production downtime across all services.

SLO-Driven Observability Platform

Technologies: Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, ELK Stack, OpenSearch, NewRelic, AWS CloudWatch

- Unified observability platform across 100+ services with SLO/SLI dashboards, burn-rate alerting, and automated incident triage runbooks - reduced incident detection time by 15% and production errors by 20%.

Cloud-Native CI/CD & Deployment Automation

Technologies: Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Argo CD, Argo Rollouts, Docker, Helm, AWS EKS

- Built and optimized CI/CD pipelines across 50+ microservices with automated testing, security scanning, artifact promotion, and Argo CD GitOps deployment - integrated canary and blue-green release strategies reducing failed deployments and improving deploy frequency.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Managed 50+ microservices on Kubernetes EKS with zero critical production incidents over 12+ months through SRE-driven observability and proactive capacity planning.
- Reduced cloud infrastructure costs by 20-25% at adidas through Graviton migration and resource optimization - documented and repeatable IaC-driven process.
- Delivered Kubernetes-to-EKS migration at Paytm Payments Bank with less than 50 minutes downtime across all banking workloads.
- Supported 30% traffic growth at Paytm Payments Bank without downtime through proactive capacity planning and autoscaling governance.
- Rockstar Award 2019 and 2020 - Paytm Payments Bank: recognized for Kubernetes platform operations and reliability engineering excellence.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AWS Certified** - Solutions Architect / DevOps
- **claude code action** - claude (2026)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering - Computer Science

Uttarakhand Technical University | Dehradun, India | Jan 2010 - Dec 2014

LANGUAGES

English | German | Hindi

RECOGNITION & IMPACT

- Rockstar Award 2019 - Paytm Payments Bank: delivered high-stakes Kubernetes EKS migration with less than 50 minutes downtime.
- Rockstar Award 2020 - Paytm Payments Bank: SLO-driven reliability programme reduced production errors by 20%.
- Published on Medium (2025): technical articles on Kubernetes operations and cloud reliability engineering.
- Volunteer contributor at adidas engineering community - knowledge sharing on DevOps automation and platform best practices.